

About the Author

Paul was introduced to drugs at the age of thirteen. At seventeen, he was arrested for robbery and murder and sentenced to life in prison. He served thirty-three years before parole was granted.

During those years, he witnessed the full cycle of addiction — men who walked out of prison determined to go straight and fell within weeks, and men who walked out with no intention of changing at all. He tried self-help books, the wisdom of man, and spent years trying to convince himself that God was not real. None of it filled the void.

It was the teaching of Freddie Anderson — a preacher whose method was always “Let’s see what the Bible says” — and the daily discipline of being in God’s Word that finally changed everything. Not the circumstances. Not the environment. The mind.

Paul obeyed the gospel, was baptized into Christ, and the man who walked into that prison at seventeen became a different man entirely. He is now sixty-five years old and the author of One Day Closer to Home and Change the Mind, Change the Man.

He writes not from theory, not from a safe distance, but from the road itself.

Someone you love is destroying himself.
Or maybe that someone is you.

You have tried everything — the conversations, the ultimatums, the promises, the programs. You have lain awake at night asking questions that have no answers and praying prayers that feel like they hit the ceiling. You have watched addiction take a person you knew and replace him with someone you don’t recognize. And you have wondered, more times than you can count, whether there is a way through this — or whether “through” is just a word people say when they don’t know what else to offer.

This book was not written by a counselor, a clinician, or a theologian. It was written by a man who was introduced to drugs at thirteen, arrested at seventeen and sentenced to life in prison, and who spent the next three decades watching addiction destroy everything it touched — including himself.

It is a straightforward examination of what God’s Word says about how the mind turns away from God, how it turns back, and why the substance was never the real problem. The gaze was.

Scripture quotations from the New American Standard Bible®.

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Change the Mind, Change the Man
Paul Hainline

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Inspired by the teaching of Freddie Anderson

Freddie Anderson, the preacher who shaped the author’s approach to Scripture, used to say: if you change a person’s mind, you change everything about them. If you don’t change their mind, you don’t change anything.

That is the argument of this book.

Change the Mind, Change the Man traces two movements that mirror the actual experience of addiction and recovery. The first five chapters follow the descent — the crisis, the progression, the guilt, the hidden prisons, and the agonizing decisions families are forced to make. The second five chapters follow the return — the biblical mechanism of change, genuine repentance, forgiveness, the long daily road of recovery, and the gospel invitation for anyone who reaches the end and realizes they need the foundation it describes.

This is not a twelve-step program. It is not a clinical treatment guide. It is a careful, honest walk through Scripture — with the Greek and Hebrew examined where they illuminate meaning — applied directly to the reality of addiction by a man who has lived every chapter of it.

Whether you are the one struggling, a family member carrying the weight, or a friend searching for answers — this book speaks to you. Not to one and then the other. To all of you at once. Because addiction is a shared story, and the road through it is walked together.